iHatch

Startup Incubation Programme

NITDA ONDI Project NINJA JICA

Course: Business Modeling

Cohort	3rd Cohort North-East
Facilitator	Abubakar Bashir
Document Type	Lecture Document
Week	Week 2
Lecture Title	Introduction of "Startup" and Idea Verification/Design Thinking
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Week 2: Customer Problem Fit (CPF)

Objective

1. Construct the problem hypothesis
2. List up the assumption of the problems
3. Identify if the customers really have the problems through interviews.

AM

1. Introduction of Empathy Map
2. Introduction of Customer Journey
3. Introduction of Javelin board
4. Introduction of Problem Interview
5. Analysis of Interview

PM

- Group Work on the Empathy Map, Customer Journey and Javelin board

Activity:

- Interview with potential customers
- Incubation manager follows up

Business Modeling 2: Customer Problem Fit (CPF)

Objective:

1. Construct the problem hypothesis.
2. List up the assumptions of the problems.
3. Identify if the customers really have the problems through interviews.

Week 2: Introduction to CPF

AM Session: Understanding Customer Empathy

1. Introduction of Empathy Map
    - Define what an Empathy Map is and its significance in understanding customer emotions and experiences.
    - Discuss how empathy maps help in identifying customer pain points and needs.
2. Introduction of Customer Journey
    - Explain the concept of the Customer Journey and its role in mapping the end-to-end experience of a customer with a product or service.
    - Highlight key touchpoints and customer interactions throughout their journey.
3. Introduction of Javelin Board
    - Introduce the Javelin Board as a tool for tracking and testing assumptions during the customer discovery process.
    - Emphasize the iterative nature of the Javelin Board in validating or invalidating hypotheses.
4. Introduction of Problem Interview
    - Define the Problem Interview and its purpose in validating assumptions about customer problems.
    - Discuss best practices for conducting effective problem interviews.

PM Session: Hands-On Group Work

- Group Work on the Empathy Map, Customer Journey, and Javelin Board (2 hours)
    - Participants work in groups to create an Empathy Map and Customer Journey for a hypothetical startup scenario.

    - Introduce a sample problem and guide groups in populating the Javelin Board with assumptions.
- Activity: Problem Interviews
    - Each group conducts problem interviews with potential customers, utilizing the tools introduced in the morning session.
    - Incubation managers provide guidance and support during the interviews.
- Analysis of Interview
    - Groups reconvene to analyze the outcomes of their problem interviews.
    - Discuss challenges faced, insights gained, and potential adjustments to the problem hypothesis.

Constructing the Problem Hypothesis in Customer Problem Fit (CPF)

The construction of a problem hypothesis is a crucial step in the Customer Problem Fit (CPF) process. It forms the foundation for your startup's understanding of the problems your potential customers are facing. A well-constructed hypothesis guides subsequent activities, including problem interviews and validation efforts. Here's a detailed guide on constructing an effective problem hypothesis:

1. Define the Problem Statement:

- Clear and Specific:
  - Clearly articulate the problem your startup aims to solve. Be specific and concise in defining the issue at hand.
- User-Centric:
  - Frame the problem from the perspective of your target users. Consider their pain points, challenges, and unmet needs.
- Avoid Prescribing Solutions:
  - Focus solely on describing the problem rather than proposing solutions at this stage. Keep the hypothesis solution-agnostic.

2. Identify the Target Customer Segment:

- Define Your Audience:
  - Clearly identify the specific customer segment or persona that is likely to face the problem.
- Demographics and Psychographics:
  - Consider both demographic and psychographic factors to create a comprehensive understanding of your target audience.

3. Formulate Assumptions:

- List Assumptions:
  - Enumerate the assumptions underlying your understanding of the problem. These assumptions will serve as hypotheses to be tested during problem interviews.

- Prioritize Assumptions:
    - Prioritize the assumptions based on their potential impact on the problem hypothesis. Focus on those that are critical to the problem-solution fit.

4. Utilize the Problem Hypothesis Template:

- Template Structure:
    - Frame your problem hypothesis using a structured template. A basic template could include:
        - User Persona: Description of the target user experiencing the problem.
        - Problem Statement: A concise statement of the problem.
        - Assumptions: A list of assumptions underlying the problem understanding.

Example Problem Hypothesis:

User Persona:

- Busy professionals (25-40 years old) who struggle to find time for nutritious meals due to their hectic schedules.

Problem Statement:

- Busy professionals lack convenient access to healthy and time-efficient meal options, resulting in compromised nutritional habits.

Assumptions:

1. Professionals prioritize convenience in their meal choices.
2. Limited time is a significant constraint in their daily routines.
3. There is a gap in the current market for healthy, on-the-go meal solutions.

5. Prepare for Validation:

- Define Validation Criteria:
    - Establish criteria for validating or invalidating the assumptions. This sets the stage for the problem interviews and subsequent testing.

- Metrics and Observations:
    - Determine the key metrics and observations that will help you assess the accuracy of your problem hypothesis.

6. Iterate Based on Learnings:

- Continuous Improvement:
    - Recognize that the problem hypothesis is an evolving document. Be prepared to iterate based on learnings from problem interviews and customer feedback.
- Adapt to New Insights:
    - Stay open to adjusting the problem hypothesis as you gain a deeper understanding of your target customers and their needs.

Nutshell:

Constructing a problem hypothesis requires a thoughtful and user-centric approach. By clearly defining the problem, identifying the target customer segment, formulating assumptions, and utilizing a structured template, startups can lay a strong foundation for the subsequent stages of the Customer Problem Fit process. The iterative nature of this process ensures that the hypothesis evolves based on real-world insights and validations.

Listing Assumptions of the Problems and Expanding Them

Identifying and listing assumptions about the problems your potential customers face is a critical step in constructing a problem hypothesis. Assumptions serve as hypotheses that need validation through problem interviews and customer interactions. Here's how you can list and expand on assumptions:

1. Prioritizing Assumptions:

- Definition:
  - Assumptions are assertions or beliefs about your target customers' problems that have not been verified. It's crucial to prioritize them based on their potential impact on the problem hypothesis.

2. Common Types of Assumptions:

- Customer Behavior:
  - Assumptions about how your target customers currently behave or react to the identified problem.
- Market Dynamics:
  - Assumptions related to the existing market conditions, competition, and trends impacting the problem.
- Value Proposition:
  - Assumptions about what aspects of your solution would be most valuable to the customers in addressing the identified problem.

3. Example Assumptions and Expansions:

Assumption 1: Professionals prioritize convenience in their meal choices.

- Expansion:
  - *Rationale:* The assumption is based on the understanding that professionals, particularly those with busy schedules, often prioritize convenience in their daily activities, including meal choices.
  - *Why It Matters:* If this assumption holds true, it suggests that a solution focusing on convenience would likely resonate with the target audience.

Assumption 2: Limited time is a significant constraint in their daily routines.

- Expansion:
  - *Rationale:* This assumption stems from the general observation that busy professionals often have tight schedules and limited time for various activities, including preparing or consuming meals.
  - *Why It Matters:* Confirming this assumption is crucial, as it validates the need for time-efficient solutions and informs the design of a product or service that aligns with users' constraints.

Assumption 3: There is a gap in the current market for healthy, on-the-go meal solutions.

- Expansion:
  - *Rationale:* This assumption is based on an analysis of existing offerings in the market and a perceived need for healthier alternatives that are also convenient for on-the-go consumption.
  - *Why It Matters:* If the market lacks viable solutions for the identified problem, it presents an opportunity for a startup to fill that gap and provide a unique value proposition.

4. Validation Criteria:

- Definition:
  - Establish clear criteria that, when met, would confirm the validity of each assumption. These criteria will guide the validation process during problem interviews.

5. Continuous Learning and Iteration:

- Iterative Process:
  - Acknowledge that assumptions are not fixed truths. Be prepared to iterate and adjust them based on real-world insights and feedback obtained through problem interviews and customer interactions.
- Adapting to New Information:
  - Stay open to adjusting assumptions as you gather new information. The goal is to refine your understanding of the customer problems and improve the accuracy of your problem hypothesis.

Nutshell:

Effectively listing and expanding on assumptions is a foundational step in the Customer Problem Fit process. By clearly articulating the rationale behind each assumption, understanding why it matters, defining validation criteria, and embracing an iterative mindset, startups can approach problem validation with a well-informed and flexible perspective. This process ensures that assumptions evolve based on real-world learnings, increasing the likelihood of constructing a robust problem hypothesis.

Identifying Customer Problems Through Interviews

Identifying if customers truly have the problems, you hypothesized is a crucial phase in the Customer Problem Fit (CPF) process. This step involves conducting problem interviews to gather insights, validate assumptions, and refine your understanding of the customer problems. Here's a detailed guide on how to effectively identify customer problems through interviews:

1. Definition:

- Purpose:
  - The primary goal of problem interviews is to engage directly with potential customers, understand their experiences, and validate or invalidate the assumptions underlying your problem hypothesis.

2. Preparation for Problem Interviews:

- Define Interview Goals:
  - Clearly outline the specific goals and objectives of the problem interviews. What insights are you seeking to gain?
- Develop Interview Protocols:
  - Create a set of open-ended questions and prompts to guide the interview. Ensure questions are designed to uncover customer pain points and challenges.
- Identify Interviewees:
  - Select a diverse group of individuals representing your target customer segment. Aim for a mix of demographics and psychographics.

3. Conducting Effective Problem Interviews:

- Build Rapport:
  - Begin the interview by establishing a rapport with the interviewee. Create a comfortable environment that encourages openness and honesty.
- Ask Open-Ended Questions:
  - Pose questions that invite detailed responses rather than simple yes or no answers. Encourage participants to share their experiences and thoughts freely.
- Active Listening:
  - Practice active listening throughout the interview. Pay attention to verbal and non-verbal cues, allowing you to delve deeper into the interviewee's perspective.

- Probe for Details:
  - When a participant mentions a challenge or pain point, probe for additional details. Understand the context, frequency, and severity of the identified problems.
- Validate or Invalidate Assumptions:
  - Use the interview as an opportunity to validate or invalidate the assumptions you listed in your problem hypothesis. Ask participants directly about their experiences related to these assumptions.

4. Analyzing Interview Insights:

- Document Findings:
  - Record detailed notes during and after each interview. Document key insights, quotes, and observations.
- Identify Patterns and Themes:
  - Analyze the collected data to identify patterns and recurring themes across multiple interviews. Look for consensus on specific problems and challenges.
- Refine Problem Hypothesis:
  - Based on the insights gathered, refine your problem hypothesis. Adjust assumptions and problem statements to better align with the realities uncovered during interviews.

5. Validation Criteria:

- Compare Findings with Validation Criteria:
  - Refer back to the validation criteria established for each assumption. Assess whether the findings from the interviews meet these criteria.
- Iterative Process:
  - Recognize that the identification of customer problems is an iterative process. Use the insights gained to continually refine your understanding and approach.

6. Post-Interview Follow-up:

- Thank Participants:
  - Express gratitude to interview participants for their time and insights. Maintain a positive relationship for potential future engagements.
- Iterate Based on Feedback:
  - If participants provide suggestions or feedback on your solution concept, use this information to iterate and enhance your understanding.

Nutshell:

Identifying customer problems through interviews is a dynamic and ongoing process. It involves not only validating assumptions but also gaining a deeper understanding of the nuances of customer experiences. By actively listening, probing for details, and iterating based on interview insights, startups can ensure a more accurate and customer-centric problem hypothesis. The ultimate goal is to refine the understanding of the problems to a point where solutions can be developed effectively.

AM Session: Understanding Customer Empathy

1. Introduction of Empathy Map:

   - Definition:

     An Empathy Map is a visual tool used to understand and empathize with the experiences, emotions, and behaviors of a target audience. It is a collaborative exercise that encourages teams to gain deeper insights into the customers' world.

   - Significance in Understanding Customer Emotions and Experiences:

     Empathy Maps are significant because they provide a structured framework for teams to walk in the shoes of their customers. This tool helps in:

- Understanding Emotional Landscape: Empathy Maps allow teams to explore the emotional aspects of customer experiences. By focusing on what customers say, think, feel, and do, teams gain a holistic view of their emotional landscape.
- Identifying Pain Points: The map guides teams in pinpointing pain points—areas where customers may be experiencing challenges, frustrations, or dissatisfaction. This is crucial for developing solutions that address real needs.
- Recognizing Gaps in Understanding: Teams can quickly identify gaps in their understanding of customers. By visualizing the customer journey and emotions, teams become aware of areas where assumptions may differ from reality.
- Enhancing Communication: Empathy Maps serve as a common visual language for team members. They enhance communication by providing a shared representation of customer insights, fostering collaboration and alignment.

2. Discussion on How Empathy Maps Help in Identifying Customer Pain Points and Needs:

- Focused Exploration:

  Empathy Maps break down the customer's experience into key components—what they see, hear, say, think, feel, and do. This focused exploration allows teams to systematically uncover pain points and needs.

- Visualizing Customer Persona:

  Through empathy mapping, teams create a visual representation of a customer persona, making it easier to empathize with and understand that individual's unique challenges and desires.

- Mapping Customer Journey:

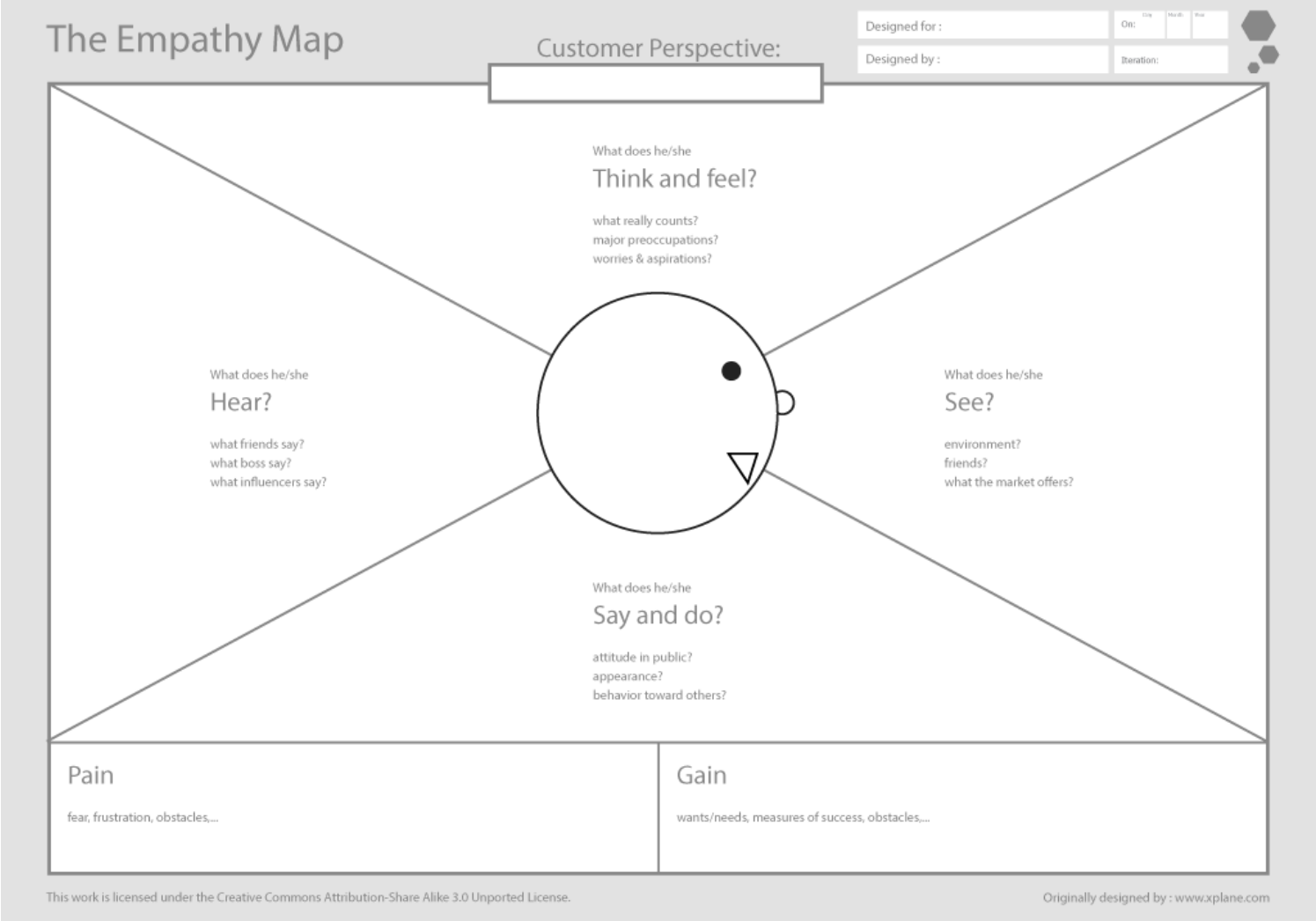
  The process involves mapping the customer journey, enabling teams to see the entire experience from the customer's perspective. This helps in identifying touchpoints where improvements can be made.

- Informing Solution Design:

  By understanding customer pain points and needs, teams can inform the design of solutions that directly address these challenges. This customer-centric approach increases the likelihood of creating products or services that resonate.

- Human-Centered Design:

  Empathy Maps align with principles of human-centered design, emphasizing the importance of empathizing with end-users. This approach ensures that solutions are not just technically viable but also deeply resonate with the intended audience.



Picture: Empathy Map

3. Application Exercise: Creating an Empathy Map (Hands-On Activity):

- Materials Needed:
  - Large sheets of paper or whiteboard
  - Markers and sticky notes.

- Steps:
  i. Define Persona: Begin by defining the persona for whom the empathy map is being created. Consider demographics, motivations, and context.
  ii. Sections of the Map:
     - Seeing: What does the persona see in their environment?
     - Hearing: What do they hear, including conversations and ambient sounds?
     - Saying/Doing: What are they saying or doing in different situations?
     - Thinking/Feeling: What thoughts or emotions might they be experiencing?
  iii. Collaborative Brainstorming: Encourage participants to brainstorm and fill in each section of the empathy map. Use sticky notes for easy adjustments and collaborative input.
  iv. Discussion: Facilitate a discussion around the completed empathy map. Encourage participants to share insights, observations, and potential pain points identified.

4. Conclusion of the Session:

- Summary:

  Summarize the key takeaways from the introduction of Empathy Maps and the hands-on activity. Highlight the importance of empathy in the design and development process.

- Transition:

  Emphasize that the insights gained from empathy mapping will inform subsequent activities, such as problem interviews, as the startup works towards achieving Customer Problem Fit.

This session aims to equip participants with a practical tool (Empathy Map) and a mindset that places the customer's experience and emotions at the center of problem understanding. The hands-on activity encourages active participation, ensuring that theoretical concepts are applied in a tangible and collaborative manner.

Example: With Real Life Startup:

"MealHub," which aims to address the nutritional needs of busy professionals who struggle to maintain a healthy diet due to time constraints.

Example of Empathy Map for MealHub:

Persona: Alex, a 32-year-old Software Engineer

1. **Seeing:**
    - *Work Environment:* A cluttered desk, multiple computer screens, and colleagues engaged in work.
    - *Kitchen at Home:* Limited groceries, takeout containers, and a microwave.
2. **Hearing:**
    - *Office:* The hum of computers, occasional phone calls, and conversations about tight project deadlines.
    - *Home:* Busy traffic outside, delivery notifications, and sounds of cooking appliances.
3. **Saying/Doing:**
    - *Office:* Expressing frustration about lack of time for proper meals, ordering takeout during lunch breaks.
    - *Home:* Quickly preparing simple meals or opting for convenient, ready-to-eat options.

4. Thinking/Feeling:
    - *Office:* Feeling stressed about work deadlines, thinking about the need for healthier food options.
    - *Home:* Desiring nutritious meals but lacking the time and energy to prepare them.

Discussion Points:

- Identified Pain Points:
    - Alex is stressed and often orders takeout due to limited time for cooking.
    - The cluttered desk indicates a potential lack of organization in managing work and personal life.
- Needs and Desires:
    - There is a clear desire for convenient and healthy meal options.
    - Time-saving solutions aligning with Alex's busy lifestyle are essential.
- Opportunities for Solution Design:
    - MealHub can explore partnerships with local restaurants to provide nutritious meal options for delivery.
    - The focus should be on convenient, ready-to-eat meals that align with Alex's work routine.

Nutshell:

Through the empathy map for MealHub, the startup gains a deeper understanding of Alex's challenges, frustrations, and aspirations related to meal choices. This visual representation serves as a valuable tool for informing the development of MealHub's solutions, ensuring they directly address the identified pain points and needs of their target audience—busy professionals like.

The Empathy Map

Customer Perspective:

Designed for :

Designed by :

On:

Iteration:

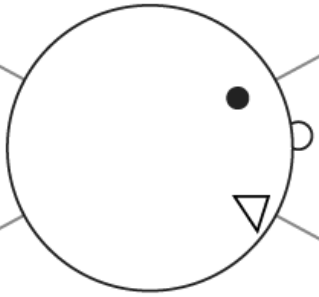
MealHub

Think & Feel:

- *Office:* Feeling stressed about work deadlines, thinking about the need for healthier food options.
- *Home:* Desiring nutritious meals but lacking the time and energy to prepare them.

Hearing:

- *Office:* The hum of computers, occasional phone calls, and conversations about tight project deadlines.
- *Home:* Busy traffic outside, delivery notifications, and sounds of cooking



SEE

- Work Environment: A cluttered desk, multiple computer screens, and colleagues engaged in work.
- Kitchen at Home: Limited groceries, takeout containers, and a microwave.

Say & Do:

- *Office:* Expressing frustration about lack of time for proper meals, ordering takeout during lunch breaks.
- *Home:* Quickly preparing simple meals or opting for

Identified Pain Points:

- Alex is stressed and often orders takeout due to limited time for cooking.
- The cluttered desk indicates a potential lack of organization in managing

Need/Desire

- There is a clear desire for convenient and healthy meal options.
- Time-saving solutions aligning with Alex's busy lifestyle are essential.

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Originally designed by : www.xplane.com

Introduction of Customer Journey:

1. Concept of the Customer Journey:

- Definition:

The Customer Journey is the comprehensive visualization and mapping of a customer's interaction and experiences with a product or service over time. It encompasses every touchpoint, from initial awareness and consideration to post-purchase interactions and ongoing engagement.

- Role in Mapping End-to-End Experience:

The Customer Journey provides a holistic understanding of how customers navigate through various stages of interaction with a brand. It goes beyond individual transactions, offering a narrative that helps businesses understand the complete lifecycle of their customers.

- Why it Matters:

Understanding the Customer Journey is essential because it allows businesses to align their strategies with customer needs and expectations. By mapping this journey, businesses can identify pain points, opportunities for improvement, and moments that significantly impact customer satisfaction and loyalty.

2. Highlighting Key Touchpoints and Interactions:

- Definition of Touchpoints:

Touchpoints are specific interactions between the customer and the business. These can include online and offline interactions, such as website visits, customer support calls, product purchases, and post-purchase feedback.

- Mapping Customer Interactions:

The Customer Journey involves identifying and mapping every touchpoint a customer has with the brand. This includes:

- **Awareness Stage:** How customers first learn about the product or service.
- **Consideration Stage:** The process of evaluating options and comparing offerings.
- **Decision Stage:** The point at which the customer decides to make a purchase.
- **Purchase Stage:** The actual transaction or acquisition of the product or service.
- **Post-Purchase Stage:** Interactions, support, and engagement after the sale.

- Key Touchpoints Throughout the Journey:
  - **Marketing Channels:** Identify where customers first encounter the brand, whether through social media, advertisements, or other marketing efforts.
  - **Website and Online Platforms:** Explore the customer's journey through the brand's digital spaces, including website navigation, product browsing, and online purchases.
  - **Customer Support:** Highlight the touchpoints where customers seek assistance or have questions.
  - **Purchase Experience:** Illustrate the steps involved in the actual purchase, from product selection to payment.
  - **Post-Purchase Engagement:** Showcase ongoing interactions, such as feedback collection, follow-up emails, or loyalty programs.
- Customer Emotions at Each Touchpoint:
  - Encourage consideration of customer emotions at each touchpoint. This adds depth to the mapping by understanding how customers feel during different stages of their journey.

3. **Why Mapping the Customer Journey Matters:**

- Enhanced Customer Understanding:
  - Mapping the Customer Journey allows businesses to step into the customer's shoes, gaining insights into motivations, challenges, and preferences at various stages.
- Improved Customer-Centric Strategies:
  - With a detailed map, businesses can develop strategies that are more customer-centric. This includes tailoring communication, optimizing touchpoints, and enhancing overall customer experience.

- Identification of Pain Points and Opportunities:
  - By identifying key touchpoints, businesses can pinpoint pain points in the customer experience and discover opportunities to create positive and memorable interactions.
- Enhanced Product and Service Design:
  - A comprehensive understanding of the Customer Journey informs product and service design, ensuring that offerings align with customer expectations and needs.

4. **Mapping Exercise (Hands-On Activity):**

- Materials Needed:
  - Large sheets of paper or whiteboard
  - Markers, sticky notes, and colored pens
- Steps:
  1. **Define Customer Stages:** Outline the stages of the Customer Journey: Awareness, Consideration, Decision, Purchase, and Post-Purchase.
  2. **Identify Touchpoints:** Collaboratively list and place key touchpoints on the map, considering both online and offline interactions.
  3. **Emphasize Customer Emotions:** Encourage participants to note potential customer emotions at each touchpoint.
  4. **Connect the Dots:** Draw lines connecting touchpoints to visually represent the customer's journey.
  5. **Discussion:** Facilitate a discussion around the mapped journey, encouraging participants to share insights, observations, and potential improvements.

5. **Conclusion of the Session:**

- Nutshell:
  - Summarize the importance of understanding the Customer Journey and how it contributes to creating a more customer-centric business.
- Transition:
  - Emphasize that insights gained from mapping the Customer Journey will inform subsequent activities, including solution design and problem interviews, in the pursuit of achieving Customer Problem Fit.

photo

Persona Info:

Objective:

	Awareness	Consideration	Decision/Purchase	Retention
Goals				
Touchpoint				
Emotions				
Level of Satisfaction	😄 ---------- 🙂 ---------- 😐 ---------- 🙁 ---------- ☹️ ----------	---------- ---------- ---------- ---------- ----------	---------- ---------- ---------- ---------- ----------	---------- ---------- ---------- ---------- ----------
Quotes or Questions				
Pain Points				
Improvement Opportunities				

Example of Customer Journey for QuickCart:

1. Awareness Stage:

- Touchpoint 1 - Social Media Ad:
  - The customer becomes aware of QuickCart through targeted social media advertisements showcasing popular products.
- Touchpoint 2 - Influencer Review:
  - The customer discovers QuickCart through a positive review from a social media influencer they follow.

2. Consideration Stage:

- Touchpoint 3 - Website Visit:
  - The customer visits QuickCart's website to explore the product range, user interface, and pricing.
- Touchpoint 4 - Customer Reviews:
  - While browsing, the customer reads reviews from other shoppers to gauge the quality and reliability of products.

3. Decision Stage:

- Touchpoint 5 - Personalized Recommendations:
  - The customer receives personalized product recommendations based on their browsing history and preferences.
- Touchpoint 6 - Limited-Time Offer Notification:
  - QuickCart sends a notification about a limited-time discount, prompting the customer to make a purchasing decision.

4. Purchase Stage:

- Touchpoint 7 - Smooth Checkout Process:
  - The customer completes a seamless checkout process, including easy payment options and transparent shipping information.
- Touchpoint 8 - Order Confirmation Email:
  - QuickCart sends a personalized order confirmation email with details and expected delivery dates.

5. Post-Purchase Stage:

- Touchpoint 9 - Delivery Tracking:
  - The customer tracks their order in real-time through QuickCart's delivery tracking system.
- Touchpoint 10 - Customer Support Chat:
  - The customer engages with QuickCart's customer support chat for any post-purchase queries or concerns.
- Touchpoint 11 - Feedback Request:
  - After delivery, QuickCart requests feedback through a follow-up email, encouraging the customer to share their experience.

Why Mapping the Customer Journey Matters for QuickCart:

- Understanding Pain Points:
  - QuickCart can identify potential pain points, such as issues in the checkout process or dissatisfaction with product recommendations.
- Optimizing Touchpoints:
  - By mapping the journey, QuickCart can optimize key touchpoints, ensuring a positive and user-friendly experience from awareness to post-purchase.
- Personalization Opportunities:
  - Recognizing touchpoints like personalized recommendations allows QuickCart to enhance its algorithms and offer more tailored suggestions.
- Customer Retention Strategies:
  - Post-purchase touchpoints like customer support and feedback requests help QuickCart develop strategies to retain customers and improve overall satisfaction.

Through a detailed Customer Journey map, QuickCart gains valuable insights into the end-to-end experience of its customers, allowing for strategic improvements and optimizations to enhance customer satisfaction and loyalty.

NB:
The above example is going to be used in an interactive session between the facilitator and the founders to populate in an empty Customer Journey Map Template.

Introduction of Javelin Board:

1. Definition of Javelin Board:

- The Javelin Board is a visual tool designed to assist startup founders and teams during the customer discovery process. It acts as a dynamic framework for tracking and testing assumptions made about the business model, target customers, and market conditions.

2. Role in Customer Discovery:

- The primary purpose of the Javelin Board is to systematically organize and validate assumptions, turning the customer discovery phase into a structured and actionable process. It serves as a guide for startups to navigate uncertainties and refine their business model based on real-world feedback.

3. Components of the Javelin Board:

- Assumptions Section:
  - Lists the critical assumptions that underlie the business model. These assumptions can relate to customer behavior, problem-solution fit, and other core elements.
- Hypotheses Section:
  - Formulates testable hypotheses based on the identified assumptions. Each hypothesis is a statement that can be validated or invalidated through experiments and interactions with potential customers.
- Tests/Experiments Section:
  - Details the specific tests or experiments planned to validate or invalidate each hypothesis. These experiments are designed to gather data and insights from the target audience.
- Results Section:
  - Captures the outcomes of conducted experiments. It includes data, feedback, and observations obtained during the customer discovery process.

4. Emphasizing the Iterative Nature:

- Continuous Learning and Adaptation:

    - Highlight that the Javelin Board is not a one-time exercise but an iterative tool. As assumptions are tested and results are obtained, startups should use this information to adapt and refine their understanding continuously.
- Dynamic Adjustments:
    - Emphasize that the Javelin Board allows for dynamic adjustments based on the evolving insights from customer interactions. Startups should be ready to pivot or refine their hypotheses as they gather more information.
- Learning from Failures:
    - Encourage a mindset that views both successes and failures as valuable learning experiences. The iterative nature of the Javelin Board allows startups to learn quickly from what works and what doesn't.

5. How Javelin Board Enhances Customer Discovery:

- Focus on Key Assumptions:
    - The Javelin Board ensures that startups focus on testing the most critical assumptions that have the highest impact on the success of the business.
- Structured Experimentation:
    - By detailing specific tests and experiments, the Javelin Board provides a structured approach to experimentation, preventing ad-hoc and unfocused efforts.
- Data-Driven Decision Making:
    - The Javelin Board promotes data-driven decision-making by capturing results and observations. It shifts the process from intuition-based decision-making to evidence-based strategies.

6. Practical Application:

- Hands-On Exercises:
    - Incorporate hands-on exercises where participants populate a Javelin Board with assumptions, hypotheses, and potential experiments related to a hypothetical startup idea.
- Group Collaboration:
    - Encourage collaborative discussions within groups to refine and critique assumptions and hypotheses, fostering a culture of collective problem-solving.

7. Integration with Lean Startup Principles:

- Alignment with Build-Measure-Learn Loop:
    - Emphasize how the Javelin Board aligns with the Lean Startup methodology's Build-Measure-Learn loop. It provides a tangible structure for implementing this iterative feedback loop.

Conclusion of the Session:

- Summary:
    - Summarize the key takeaways, emphasizing the Javelin Board as a practical and effective tool for startups engaged in the customer discovery process.
- Transition:
    - Emphasize that the insights gained from the Javelin Board will inform subsequent actions, including adjustments to the business model, product development, and further customer engagement.

Javelin BIGJUMP

Experiment Board

Project Name:

Team Leader Name:

Start here. Brainstorm with stickies, pull it over to the right to start your experiment.

Who is your customer? Be as specific as possible. Time Limit: 5 Min

What is the problem? Phrase it from your customer's perspective. Time Limit: 5 Min

Define the solution only after you have validated a problem worth solving. Time Limit: 5 Min

List the assumptions that must hold true, for your hypothesis to be true. Time Limit: 10 Min

Need help? Use these sentences to help construct your experiment.

To form a Customer/Problem Hypothesis:
I believe my customer has a problem achieving this goal.

To form a Problem/Solution Hypothesis:
I believe this solution will result in quantifiable outcome.

To form your Assumptions:
In order for hypothesis to be true, assumption needs to be true.

To identify your Riskiest Assumption:
The assumption with the least amount of data, and core to the viability of my hypothesis is...

Determine how you will test it:
The least expensive way to test my assumption is...

Determine what success looks like:
I will run experiment with # of customers and expect a strong signal from # of customers.

Experiments	1	2	3	4	5
Customer					
Problem					
Solution					
Riskiest Assumption					
Method & Success Criterion					
GET OUT OF THE BUILDING!					
Result & Decision					
Learning					

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Picture: Javelin Board Template

Example of Javelin Board for FitFuel:

"FitFuel," which aims to provide personalized nutrition plans and meal delivery services for fitness enthusiasts. FitFuel wants to test assumptions related to its target customer's preferences, willingness to pay for premium meal plans, and the effectiveness of its personalized nutrition algorithms.

1. Assumptions:

- Assumption 1:
  - Fitness enthusiasts are willing to pay a premium for personalized nutrition plans.
- Assumption 2:
  - The target market values the convenience of meal delivery services tailored to their fitness goals.

2. Hypotheses:

- Hypothesis 1:
  - If FitFuel offers a premium personalized nutrition plan at a competitive price point, fitness enthusiasts will be more likely to subscribe.
- Hypothesis 2:
  - If FitFuel provides a convenient and reliable meal delivery service aligned with customers' fitness routines, satisfaction and retention will increase.

3. Tests/Experiments:

- Experiment 1:
  - Develop a sample personalized nutrition plan and offer it to a focus group of fitness enthusiasts. Measure their willingness to pay and gather feedback.
- Experiment 2:
  - Launch a pilot meal delivery service for a limited group of customers. Track delivery times, customer satisfaction, and retention rates.

4. Results:

- Result 1:
  - Feedback from the focus group indicates a high willingness to pay for personalized plans, but customers express concerns about affordability for long-term subscriptions.
- Result 2:
  - The pilot meal delivery service receives positive feedback for convenience and quality, but some customers report delivery delays.

5. Adjustments and Iterations:

- Adjustment 1:
  - Modify pricing strategies for personalized plans, considering more flexible subscription options and discounts for long-term commitments.
- Adjustment 2:
  - Optimize the logistics and delivery process to address delays and enhance overall customer experience.

6. Continuous Learning:

- Learning:
  - FitFuel learns that while customers value personalization, the pricing model needs refinement for wider market acceptance. Delivery logistics also require ongoing optimization.

7. Integration with Lean Startup Principles:

- Build-Measure-Learn Loop:
  - FitFuel integrates the Javelin Board into its Build-Measure-Learn loop, ensuring a continuous cycle of testing, learning, and adapting.

This example demonstrates how FitFuel uses the Javelin Board to systematically test assumptions, gather data through experiments, and adjust its strategies based on real-world feedback. The iterative nature of the Javelin Board enables FitFuel to refine its business model and enhance its offerings, ultimately increasing the likelihood of achieving product-market fit.

Introduction of Problem Interview:

1. Definition of Problem Interview:

A Problem Interview is a structured and exploratory conversation with potential customers aimed at understanding their pain points, challenges, and needs. It is a crucial step in the customer discovery process, specifically focused on validating assumptions related to the problems your startup aims to solve.

2. Purpose in Validating Assumptions:

- Understanding Customer Problems:
  - The primary purpose of the Problem Interview is to gain a deep understanding of the problems and challenges your target customers face. It helps in validating or invalidating assumptions about the nature and significance of these problems.
- Refining Problem-Solution Fit:
  - By directly engaging with potential customers, startups can refine their understanding of the problem-solution fit. The insights gained from problem interviews inform adjustments to the solution and overall business strategy.

3. Best Practices for Conducting Effective Problem Interviews:

- Empathy and Open-Mindedness:
  - Approach problem interviews with empathy and an open mind. Avoid preconceived notions and be genuinely curious about the experiences and perspectives of the interviewees.
- Clearly Defined Objectives:
  - Clearly define the objectives of the problem interview. Have specific hypotheses or assumptions that you aim to validate or invalidate through the conversation.
- Use Open-Ended Questions:
  - Frame questions in a way that encourages detailed and open-ended responses. Avoid leading questions that might bias the interviewee's answers.
- Active Listening:
  - Practice active listening during the interview. Pay close attention to what the interviewee is saying, and ask follow-up questions to delve deeper into their experiences.
- Probe for Details:

    - Probe for specific details about situations, contexts, and emotions related to the identified problems. The goal is to uncover nuanced insights that go beyond surface-level observations.
- Avoid Pitching Solutions:
    - Resist the urge to pitch your solution during the problem interview. The focus should solely be on understanding the customer's perspective on the identified problems.
- Diverse Interviewee Pool:
    - Conduct problem interviews with a diverse group of potential customers. This ensures a comprehensive understanding of the various facets of the identified problems.
- Iterative Approach:
    - Approach problem interviews as an iterative process. Use the insights gathered from one set of interviews to refine your understanding and conduct subsequent interviews with a more informed perspective.
- Record and Analyze Findings:
    - Record detailed notes during problem interviews and systematically analyze the findings afterward. Look for patterns, commonalities, and variations in the responses.
- Adjust and Iterate:
    - Based on the insights obtained, be willing to adjust and iterate on your assumptions. This might involve refining the problem statement, adjusting target customer segments, or even pivoting the overall business strategy.
- Continuous Learning:
    - Consider problem interviews as opportunities for continuous learning. Embrace the feedback and insights gained as valuable inputs for the evolution of your startup.

4. Integration with Lean Startup Principles:

- Lean Startup Methodology:
    - Emphasize how problem interviews align with the Lean Startup methodology, particularly in the Build-Measure-Learn loop. Problem interviews contribute to the "Learn" phase, guiding subsequent actions and iterations.

Conclusion of the Session:

- Summary:
  - Summarize the importance of problem interviews in the customer discovery process and how they contribute to refining the understanding of customer problems.
- Transition:
  - Emphasize that the insights gained from problem interviews will feed into subsequent activities, including solution ideation, prototype development, and further customer engagement.

Example of Problem Interview for a Startup “GreenGrocer”:

"GreenGrocer," that aims to address the problem of food waste in households. The founders of GreenGrocer assume that a significant challenge for consumers is the difficulty in managing perishable items and minimizing food waste. They conduct problem interviews to validate these assumptions.

1. Assumptions:

- Assumption 1:
  - Consumers face challenges in managing perishable items, leading to food waste.
- Assumption 2:
  - There is a need for a solution that helps consumers plan and optimize their grocery purchases to reduce waste.

2. Problem Interview Setup:

- Objective:
  - Validate assumptions about consumers' challenges in managing perishable items and their openness to a solution like GreenGrocer.
- Target Audience:
  - Conduct problem interviews with individuals who actively engage in grocery shopping and express concern about food waste.

3. Interview Process:

- Open-Ended Questions:
  - Begin the interview with open-ended questions such as, "Can you tell me about your typical grocery shopping routine?" This encourages participants to share their experiences freely.
- Probe for Challenges:
  - Delve deeper into the challenges they face regarding perishable items. Ask questions like, "Do you often find yourself throwing away unused fruits and vegetables?"
- Explore Emotions:

    - Probe for emotional aspects related to food waste, asking questions like, "How do you feel when you have to discard food?"
- Feedback on Potential Solution:
    - Towards the end of the interview, introduce the concept of GreenGrocer without going into detailed solutions. Ask for their thoughts on a service that helps plan grocery purchases to minimize waste.

4. Results and Insights:

- Result 1:
    - Participants express frustration about regularly discarding unused produce due to spoilage.
- Result 2:
    - Many participants highlight challenges in meal planning and often buy more than needed, contributing to food waste.
- Result 3:
    - Positive reception to the idea of a service like GreenGrocer that provides personalized meal plans and helps optimize grocery purchases.

5. Adjustments and Iterations:

- Adjustment 1:
    - GreenGrocer refines its value proposition to emphasize personalized meal planning and waste reduction.
- Adjustment 2:
    - The startup considers integrating features that help users track the freshness of perishable items.

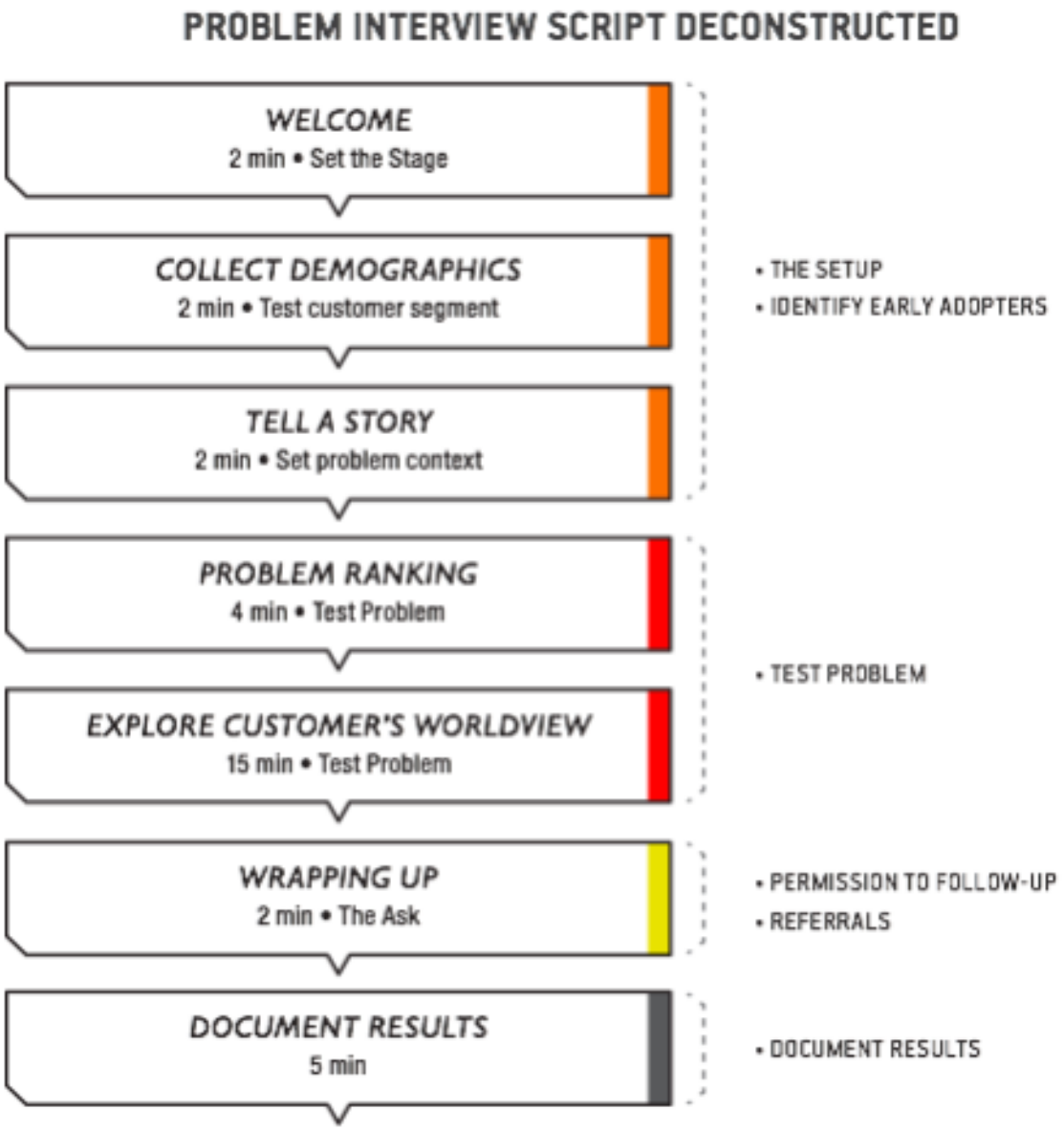
6. Continuous Learning:

- Learning:
    - The problem interviews reveal that consumers are indeed facing challenges related to food waste and are receptive to a solution like GreenGrocer. Continuous learning involves refining the solution based on specific pain points uncovered during interviews.

7. Integration with Lean Startup Principles:

- Build-Measure-Learn Loop:
    - GreenGrocer integrates insights from problem interviews into the Build-Measure-Learn loop. The refined understanding of customer problems guides subsequent actions in developing and testing the solution.

This example illustrates how problem interviews for GreenGrocer help validate assumptions, uncover specific pain points, and inform adjustments to the startup's value proposition. The iterative process contributes to the startup's evolution, ensuring that the solution aligns more closely with the real needs and challenges of its target audience.



Picture: Problem Interview Script Deconstruct

Core Example of Problem Interview Script Deconstruct Case study of FitBuddy Startup:

Creating a problem interview script involves carefully crafting questions and prompts to uncover specific insights about the challenges and pain points your target audience faces. Below is a deconstruction of a problem interview script for a hypothetical startup, "FitBuddy," which aims to address challenges related to maintaining a consistent fitness routine.

Problem Interview Script Deconstruction:

Introduction:

1. Greeting and Context:
    - Introduce yourself, provide context about the startup, and express gratitude for the participant's time.
2. Objective Clarification:
    - Clearly state the objective of the interview, emphasizing that it is focused on understanding the challenges individuals face in maintaining a regular fitness routine.

Background Questions:

3. Fitness Routine Overview:
    - "Can you walk me through your typical fitness routine? What types of exercises or activities do you engage in?"
4. Motivation:
    - "What motivates you to stay active and maintain a fitness routine?"

Challenges Exploration:

5. Barriers to Consistency:
    - "Are there specific challenges or barriers that you've encountered in staying consistent with your fitness routine?"
6. Time Constraints:
    - "How do time constraints impact your ability to dedicate time to exercise regularly?"
7. Motivational Challenges:
    - "Have you ever faced motivational challenges? What tends to demotivate you from sticking to your fitness routine?"

Technology and Solutions:

8. Use of Fitness Apps:
    - "Do you currently use any fitness apps or technology to support your fitness journey? If yes, which ones, and how satisfied are you with them?"
9. Perceived Solutions:
    - "If there were an ideal solution to help you overcome the challenges you mentioned, what features or aspects would it include?"

Feedback on FitBuddy Concept:

10. Introduction of FitBuddy:
    - "Now, I'd like to introduce you to FitBuddy, a fitness app designed to address some of these challenges. How does the concept of having a personalized fitness companion sound to you?"
11. Initial Reaction:
    - "What are your initial thoughts or reactions to the idea of a fitness app like FitBuddy?"
12. FitBuddy Features:
    - "Are there specific features or functionalities you would like to see in a fitness companion app to make it more appealing and useful for you?"

Closing Questions:

13. Feedback on Interview:
    - "Is there anything else you would like to share or any feedback you have about our discussion today?"
14. Follow-Up Interest:
    - "Would you be interested in participating in future discussions or testing as we develop FitBuddy further?"

Conclusion:

15. Thank You and Next Steps:
    - Express gratitude for their time, summarize key points, and mention any follow-up steps or actions.

Deconstruction Explanation:

- Objective Clarity:
  - The script begins with a clear statement of the interview's objective, setting the tone for a focused discussion on fitness routine challenges.
- Gradual Exploration:
  - The script gradually explores challenges, starting with general barriers and then delving into specific factors like time constraints and motivation.
- Technology Usage:
  - Understands the participant's current use of technology in their fitness journey to gauge familiarity and expectations.
- Introduction of FitBuddy:
  - Introduces the startup concept mid-interview, allowing for unbiased initial reactions before delving into specific features.
- Feedback and Iteration:
  - Gathers feedback on the FitBuddy concept, ensuring that the startup can iterate and refine its offering based on user input.
- Closing Questions:
  - Concludes with open-ended questions, giving participants an opportunity to share additional thoughts and express interest in future involvement.

This deconstructed problem interview script provides a structured approach to understanding the challenges faced by potential users and gathering valuable insights to inform the development and refinement of the FitBuddy app.

PM Session: Group Work on Empathy Map, Customer Journey, and Javelin Board

Group Work Overview:

1. Introduction:
    - Briefly recap the importance of empathy, customer journey mapping, and the Javelin Board in the startup process.
2. Formation of Groups:
    - Divide the participants into small groups, ensuring a mix of skills and perspectives within each group.
3. Distribution of Templates:
    - Provide each group with templates for creating an Empathy Map, Customer Journey Map, and Javelin Board. These templates can be physical or digital, depending on the available resources.

Empathy Map Group Work:

4. Empathy Map Instructions:
    - Instruct each group to collaboratively fill out an Empathy Map for a hypothetical user persona. Encourage them to consider the persona's thoughts, feelings, needs, and pain points related to the startup's problem space.
5. Discussion and Collaboration:
    - Facilitate group discussions, encouraging participants to share diverse perspectives and insights. Ensure that each aspect of the Empathy Map is well-covered.
6. Presentation Preparation:
    - Ask each group to prepare a brief presentation summarizing their Empathy Map findings. Emphasize the importance of storytelling and creating a narrative around the user persona.

Customer Journey Map Group Work:

7. Customer Journey Map Instructions:
    - Instruct groups to create a Customer Journey Map for the same hypothetical user persona. Guide them in identifying key touchpoints, actions, emotions, and pain points throughout the user's interaction with the startup.
8. Interactive Discussions:

- Facilitate interactive discussions within the groups to ensure a comprehensive understanding of the user's journey. Encourage participants to consider both online and offline touchpoints.

9. Presentation Preparation:
    - Ask each group to prepare a presentation summarizing their Customer Journey Map. Emphasize the visualization of the user's experience and the identification of critical moments.

Javelin Board Group Work:

10. Javelin Board Instructions:
    - Guide groups in creating a Javelin Board, focusing on testing assumptions related to the startup's problem and solution hypotheses. Provide guidance on framing hypotheses and designing practical experiments.
11. Collaborative Testing Scenarios:
    - Encourage collaboration within groups to develop realistic testing scenarios for their hypotheses. Discuss potential challenges and how these tests will provide actionable insights.
12. Presentation Preparation:
    - Instruct each group to prepare a presentation summarizing their Javelin Board. Highlight the assumptions tested, the experiments conducted, and the results obtained.

Activity: Interview with Potential Customers

13. Interview Planning:
    - Instruct each group to plan and conduct interviews with potential customers based on the assumptions and hypotheses outlined in their Javelin Board. Provide guidelines on effective interview techniques.
14. Data Collection:
    - Groups should collect qualitative and quantitative data during the interviews, focusing on validating or invalidating their assumptions.
15. Incubation Manager Follow-Up:
    - The incubation manager follows up with each group to discuss the interview outcomes, address any challenges faced, and provide guidance on interpreting the results.
16. Reflection:

- Allocate time for groups to reflect on the interview process, noting key insights, unexpected findings, and areas for further exploration.

Conclusion:

17. Group Presentations:
    - Each group presents their findings from the Empathy Map, Customer Journey Map, and Javelin Board, sharing insights gained and lessons learned during the group work and interviews.
18. Discussion and Synthesis:
    - Facilitate a discussion that synthesizes common themes across groups, highlighting overarching insights and challenges. Emphasize the importance of continuous learning and iteration.
19. Next Steps:
    - Discuss next steps based on the insights gathered. Guide participants in how to incorporate these findings into the startup development process.

This structured PM session aims to leverage group collaboration to create meaningful artifacts (Empathy Map, Customer Journey Map, and Javelin Board) and conduct real-world interviews with potential customers. The involvement of the incubation manager ensures that the interview outcomes are effectively analyzed, and participants receive guidance on interpreting and applying the results to the startup's development.